

Module -3

Written Communication

Written Communication: Purpose of writing, Clarity in writing, Principles of effective writing, Approaching the writing process systematically: The 3X3 writing process for business communication Pre writing, Writing, Revising. Audience analysis, Writing Positive, Neutral, Persuasive and Bad-news Messages. Types of Written Communication In Business: Business Letters: Introduction To Business Letters, Types of Business Letters, Writing Routine And Persuasive Letters, Positive And Negative Messages Writing, Employee Reviews, Recommendation Letters, Thank You Letters

Introduction

In Business Communication, writing can be called effective only if its easy for the reader to read and to understand, to remember and act upon it.

- ✕ What attracts you to a document?
- ✕ How do you select what to read?
- ✕ How do you choose to throw away/ignore some?
- ✕ What sustains your interest?
- ✕ What motivates you to keep reading?
- Written communication has great significance in today's business world. It is an innovative activity of the mind.
- Effective written communication is essential for preparing worthy promotional materials for business development. Speech came before writing.
- But writing is more unique and formal than speech. Effective writing involves careful choice of words, their organization in correct order in sentences formation as well as cohesive composition of sentences.
- Also, writing is more valid and reliable than speech. But while speech is spontaneous, writing causes delay and takes time as feedback is not immediate.

Purpose of Writing

There are mainly two purposes of communication in business situations.

- ✕ To inform
- ✕ To persuade

Writing to Inform

- ✗ When the writer seeks to give information and offers to explain it, the writing is called **informative writing**

checklist:

- ✗ Does it offer complete and exact information?
- ✗ Does it make good reading?

Writing to persuade

- ✗ Persuasive writing focuses on the reader.
- ✗ The writer attempts to change the reader's thinking, and bring it closer to his own way of thinking

check list:

- ✗ Does it focus on the reader?
- ✗ Does it clearly follow a logical arrangement of thought and reasoning?

Advantages of WC

- Written communication helps in laying down apparent principles, policies and rules for running of an organization.
- It is a permanent means of communication. Thus, it is useful where record maintenance is required.
- It assists in proper delegation of responsibilities. While in case of oral communication, it is impossible to fix and delegate responsibilities on the grounds of speech as it can be taken back by the speaker or he may refuse to acknowledge.
- Written communication is more precise and explicit.
- Effective written communication develops and enhances an organization's image.
- It provides ready records and references.
- Legal defenses can depend upon written communication as it provides valid records.

Disadvantages of WC

- Too much paper work and e-mails burden is involved.
- Written communication is time-consuming as the feedback is not immediate. The encoding and sending of message takes time.

- Also, if the receivers of the written message are separated by distance and if they need to clear their doubts, the response is not spontaneous.
- Effective written communication requires great skills and competencies in language and vocabulary use. Poor writing skills and quality have a negative impact on organization's reputation.

Clarity in writing

Writing Something Important? Want to be Sure it's Very Clear?

1. Be very clear about what it is you want to convey.
2. Have a good understanding of who you want to convey it to Focus on that audience .
3. Decide on an approach to your reader or audience and match your writing style to that approach; avoid mixing approaches and styles.
4. Plan out the presentation of your ideas from a beginning that is (a) acceptable to your audience, (b) encourages their interest, and (c) helps them track with you while they read on.
5. clearly envision the end result or objective or product of your writing, and build up to it connectedly and as strongly as you can, and put it in place like an anchor for the whole piece.
6. When your design and objective are clear to you, start writing.
7. Use words and expressions that your audience is familiar with; if you need or want to use a term, abbreviation, or phrase outside of their presumed vocabulary.
8. Design your paragraphs and sentences for greatest impact as your actual writing builds up to the climax and completion of your message and request for action.
9. The purpose of business writing is to achieve the understanding & reaction needed in the quickest & most economical way.

Principles of effective writing

1. Clear:

The basic principles of effective writing are the message should be presented 'clearly'. Message should be easily understandable by the reader.

2. Concise:

Irrelevant and unnecessary words should be eliminated. The message should be short and complete. Unnecessary words and long sentences interrupt reader's attention and failed to achieve the goal.

3. Complete:

The message should be short, but in the same time it should be complete. That is, all the required information must be provided by the writer.

4. Correct:

A concise and complete but wrong message is meaningless. Thus the given message must be authentic and grammatically, correct. Wrong information not only disturbs the effectiveness of writing but also adversely affect the goodwill of the firm.

5. Courteous:

Last but not the least tool for effective writing is 'courtesy'. By emphasizing reader's interest and selecting right words creates courtesy. Courteous tone in the writing not only serves the specific purpose but also boost up the image of the organization.

6. Accuracy**7. Brevity****8. Clarity****Failures to make a text readable**

- Too many words
- Involved complex, long sentences and clauses.
- Unpleasant tone
- Poor organization, confused flow, lack of coherence
- High density of ideas
- Lacking interest, boring
- Containing too many modifiers
- Reader's lack of motivation
- Reader's lack of prior knowledge of the subject
- Content being irrelevant to the reader
- Poor appearance and poor quality paper

For an Effective Text

- Clear and simple in style and vocabulary; no jargon or phrases.
- Written in precise language without redundant words or phrases.

- Well organized information/ explanation with structure that is easy to grasp, and flow that facilitates reading.
- Substantiated and supported with verifiable proof.
- Focused on the reader and reader's needs.
- In a format that is suitable for the content.
- Attractive in appearance.

Approaching the Writing process systematically

- Practicing a methodical approach brings certain rewards in production of better texts in less time.
- It requires change of mindset and patience to spend time on planning and preparing, without feeling pushed to pen paper.
- It requires the persistence and tenacity of mind to revise what has been written.

Basics of writing:

1. Purposeful.
2. Economical way.
3. Reader oriented.

3X3 Writing Process for Business Communication

The 3x3 approach to the task of writing divides into three phases

Phase 1: Pre Writing

- ✗ Analyze
- ✗ Anticipate
- ✗ Adapt

Phase 2: Writing

- ✗ Research
- ✗ Organize
- ✗ Compose

Phase 3: Revising

- ✗ Revise

- ✕ Proof-read
- ✕ Evaluate
- **Pre-writing (Phase 1)**

Planning activities should contribute towards getting into the right frame of mind and adopting the right attitude

Preparation has to be made by collecting material and organizing it

- **Planning Stage**
- **Analyzing** a situation begins with making a clear statement of the **problem**
- Necessary to look the background of the situation
- The writer clarify the **purpose** of the communication
- The writer must know what response he wants from the audience
- Analyze the **audience** thoroughly
- Choose the appropriate channel
- **Anticipate and Adapt**

Anticipate what the audience's needs and responses might be.

- kind of language
- Background information

Adapting it involves how to create a message that suits the audience in tone structure and accomplishes the writer's goal

- View from reader's perspective and reader benefits should be highlighted
- **Preparation (Phase 2) writing stage**
- It begins with **Research** to collect together all the information related to the situation
- **Organizing** the material and structuring the message is the all-important mental exercise to be carefully done
- Writing, the writing tasks is also called as **Composing** It is difficult to draw a line between the mental process of putting ideas into words and physical tasks of writing words
- **Revising (Phase 3)**
- Revise the **content , organization and style**

- Is the purpose of document is clear?
- Does the order of the points make sense?
- Are the words and sentence clear and within the audience's comprehension?

Proof reading, mistakes in grammar, spelling, punctuation, vocabulary and sentence structure

Revising: revision is not limited to one time

It takes 4 times or more, it takes longest time to do it.

Proof-reading: mistakes in grammar, spelling , punctuation, vocabulary, sentence structure are corrected a this stage

Evaluation: Last look to evaluate the effectiveness Evaluation is a very responsible task for a management level person

- **Specific writing features**
- Organization.
- Coherence
- Appropriate tone.
- Readability: Clarity, conciseness, parallel structure.
- **Coherence – One of the principle**

Coherence is logical connection of ideas that makes any composition easy to read. It is the product of two factors.

- ✓ **Paragraph unity**
- ✓ **Sentence cohesion**
 - ❖ It contains more specific information than the topic sentence and,
 - ❖ It maintains the same focus of attention as the topic sentence
- **Coherence**

Repetition: try using a synonym provided that it will not confuse readers

Parallelism: repeating a sentence structure is a useful way to create cohesion

Enumeration:

- It can link ideas that are otherwise completely unconnected
- It looks formal and distinctive

- It promotes the parallelism method of cohesion

In a multi-media environment, the written text can be enriched by the use of animation, video-clips and audio-clips.

Demerits:

- ✗ Some will become over depend on computer for spelling and grammar
- ✗ Some fail to realize the importance copyright rules
- **Electronic writing Features**
 - Drafts were written by hand edited and corrected.
 - Re-written or re-typed to get a proper view of the edited draft
 - The electronic screen has affected every step of the process, making its easier
- ✗ Spell checks, auto-correction, and grammar checks, facilitated the reduction of errors in the draft for layout such as italics, underling, bold face, bullet points are easier than hand written
- ✗ Enrichment of the text became easier with facilities for thesaurus hunt for synonyms, and for insertion of graphics
- ✗ Doubtful information or grammar points can be checked on various websites.
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What is audience analysis?

Audience analysis is the process of identifying your audience and collecting information about them. Before delivering the speech, you should know the age group, expertise level, needs, expectations, value system, attitudes, and beliefs of your audience.

Adapting your speech according to the types of audiences is likely to generate a better response.

Some audience analysis factors are as follows:

- Audience expectations about the occasion of the speech, its topic, and the personality of the speaker
- Audience's knowledge or familiarity with the topic
- Audience's attitude or approach towards the topic
- Audience size and its ability to listen
- Why do you think accomplished speakers such as Mahatma Gandhi, Nelson Mandela, Swami Vivekananda, and Steve Jobs won their audiences over? They knew the importance of audience analysis. The content and style of their speeches touched on subjects that were close to the hearts of their audience.
- **The importance of audience analysis**
- Analyzing different types of audiences will lead you to crucial insights that can help you in creating a positive bond with the audience. For example, if you know that 70% of the audience is female, thoroughly researched references to feminism or women empowerment will likely be received well.
- Audience analysis prevents you from delivering an incorrect or offensive message. It will also warn you against delivering a message that can be easily misinterpreted. It will help you speak to your audience in the language they understand and appreciate. Let's now look at the different types of audience analysis.

Types of audience analysis

- **Demographic Analysis**
- Demographic audience analysis includes taking in factors such as age, gender, race, culture, ethnicity, marital status, socio-economic conditions, education, occupation, etc. For example, if the subject is healthcare and the audience is in their late fifties, your speech should be geared towards age-appropriate recommendations for a healthy lifestyle.
- **Psychographic Analysis**
- Psychographic is one of the types of audience analysis that covers understanding the attitudes, beliefs, values and thinking patterns of your audience.
- Values such as freedom, honesty, justice, patriotism, equality are universal and cherished by most audiences. The audience is likely to respect you and want to hear from you if your speech reflects any of these values.
- **Situational Analysis**
- Situational audience analysis includes factors such as audience size, the occasion, the room layout, the stage layout, motivation, or interest level of the audience.

- If your audience is smaller, there is a possibility of developing a [rapport](#) with each member. Tailor your data and delivery to the occasion—what you will say at a corporate conference will differ widely from your talk at a momentous family function.
- **Multicultural Analysis**
- The content of your speech should acknowledge the diversity of your audience.
- Different cultures have different value systems and behavior patterns. Being judgemental in your speech creates a negative impact. Cultural sensitivity and inclusivity should be part of your audience analysis.
- Some other types of audience analysis are:
 - Is it a niche audience with a high level of expertise or a general audience without any specialization in the subject matter? Consider this before using jargon or terms of art.
 - Why are they investing their time in your speech? What inputs do they need from you?
 - Do a knowledge analysis of your audience and put your best foot forward. Let your confidence and competence win over the audience.

Final Thoughts

- Understand the importance of audience analysis. Always keep in mind that the lack of proper audience analysis will hamper your credibility as a speaker. Take your planning to the next level with Harappa's [Speaking Effectively](#) course.
- The course is designed to help you use nonverbal cues to speak powerfully. You will also learn about Aristotle's Appeals. It is an important framework comprising three appeals that enhance the quality of your speech: reasoning, credibility, and emotion. With the help of this framework, you can learn how to captivate, engage, and persuade your audience.
- Explore topics such as [Public Speaking](#), [The Rule of Three](#), [Tone of Voice](#), [7 C's of communication](#), and the [Elements of Communication](#) from our Harappa Diaries blog section to ace your soft skills.

Positive, Negative, and Persuasive Messages

- All business messages fit across to two broad categories with an overlapping third category. There are communications where the receiver is expected to have a positive or neutral reaction, and there are communications about which receivers may have a more negative reaction. The image of the continuum below is focused on audience reaction to a message.

- We'll discuss exactly how to write these messages later in this module when we discuss the three-part writing process. For now we'll focus on how to determine which type of message fits your audience.
- **Positive Messages**
- Positive messages include messages where the audience is expected to react in a neutral to positive manner. Positive messages tend to consist of routine or good news. These messages might be items such as congratulations, confirmations, directions, simple credit requests, or credit approvals. Also included in this category might be denials that are somewhat routine or expected. This could be something like a parking lot closure that inconveniences employees, but in a minor way. As strange as this sounds, sympathy messages are in this category as well. Sympathy messages are routine since they will not be a surprise to the receiver.

Consider the message to be a positive message structure when:

- The receiver likes or expects this news (product shipped on time)
- The receiver needs little education or background to understand the news (travel arrangement for the conference)
- The receiver considers the message routine, even if not completely positive (parking lot closed for three days for new striping)
- **Negative Messages**
- Negative messages include messages where the audience is expected to react in a negative manner. Negative messages consist of bad news. In these messages, the sender's goal is to convey the bad news in a manner that preserves the business relationship. While the sender must deliver bad news, the sender wants to avoid an employee quitting or a customer finding another vendor. These messages might be items such as refusal to provide a refund, cancellation of an event, inability to support an event and more.

Consider the message to be a negative communication when:

- The receiver may be displeased (cost for repair is the receiver's, not the utility company's)
- The receiver needs a little persuasion (new log-on procedure takes longer but is more secure)
- The receiver may be somewhat uncomfortable (new badging system underway because employees have been sharing badges)

- **Persuasive Messages**

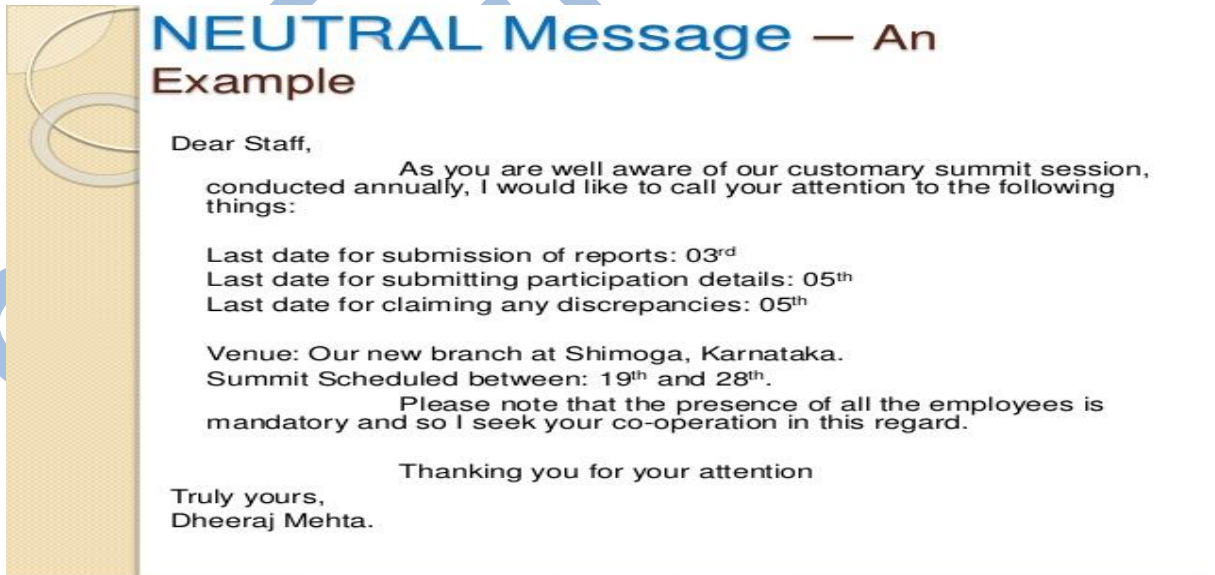
- The third, overlapping category is persuasive messages. With this category, the audience is expected to need encouragement in order to act as the sender desires. In some cases, the receiver is more like a positive audience; for example, when you're asking for a recommendation letter or when you're inviting someone to attend an after-hours work function. In other cases, the receiver is more like a negative audience; for example, when you're requesting additional payment as a result of a shared error or when you're providing an extension to an impending due date.

Consider the message a persuasive communication when:

- The receiver may be reluctant (please speak to the new employee group)
- The receiver is being asked a favor (please write recommendation letter)
- The receiver may be invited to something somewhat outside regular duties (please supervise a new book club that will meet on campus after work)

Neutral message

- A **neutral message** is one that does not provoke emotion. To clarify, good news might be a job offer. **Neutral** news might be that the company you applied to confirmed the receipt of your resume. Deductive **messages** are pretty easy to draft.



NEUTRAL Message — An Example

Dear Staff,

As you are well aware of our customary summit session, conducted annually, I would like to call your attention to the following things:

Last date for submission of reports: 03rd
 Last date for submitting participation details: 05th
 Last date for claiming any discrepancies: 05th

Venue: Our new branch at Shimoga, Karnataka.
 Summit Scheduled between: 19th and 28th.

Please note that the presence of all the employees is mandatory and so I seek your co-operation in this regard.

Thanking you for your attention

Truly yours,
 Dheeraj Mehta.

Business letters and reports

Introduction to business letters

- Writing good business letters is an art that all technical people should master.
- when writing a business letter, the writer produces a one-sided conversation with the reader in the sense that he/she has to anticipate the reader's questions and provide answers to those questions.
- Letters are the most widely used form of written communication which can be between friends on matters of personal interests or between individuals, firms or companies on matters of trade & commerce.

What is a Business Letter?

- A **business letter** is a letter written in formal language, usually used when writing from one business organization to another, or for correspondence between such organizations and their customers, clients and other external parties.
- Commercial letters are refers to all letters that are used in conducting different types of business transactions with the outside world.
- Writing a letter can be the most challenging as well as rewarding.
- Challenging, since every letters are trials.
- Rewarding, since nothing can give more satisfaction than the feeling of achievement, without face-to-face communication.
- Writing letters is both an art and technique.

Principles of drafting

- ❖ Determine the purpose of the message
- ❖ Plan the message
- ❖ Use natural conversation language
- ❖ Be compact & clear
- ❖ Be brief but not too brief
- ❖ Be courteous, considerate, friendly & helpful.

Essentials of an business letters

- ☐ Keep readers interest in mind
- ☐ Tone should be correct

- ☐ Be sincere
- ☐ To the point
- ☐ Prefer active voice
- ☐ Be consistent
- ☐ Use concrete words
- ☐ Persuasion
- ☐ Conciseness
- ☐ Positive & pleasant approach.

Structure/ parts of business letters

- ℓ Letterhead
- ℓ Date
- ℓ Inside name & address
- ℓ Courtesy title: Mr., ms, M/S, etc.....
- ℓ Salutation: Dear sir/ madam
- ℓ Message:
- ℓ Complimentary closure: Your truly
- ℓ Signature & designation
- ℓ Reference initials
- ℓ Enclosure & copy line
- ℓ Steps in writing a letter

Margins 1-1.5"

[Your Name] (1)
 [Address]
 [Phone]
 [Current Date] (2)
 Re: [What this letter is in reference to] (3)

[CERTIFIED MAIL] (4)
 [PERSONAL] (5)

[Recipient's Name] (6)
 [Company Name]
 [Address]

Attention [Recipient's Name] (7)

Dear [Recipient's Name]: (8)

[SUBJECT] (9)

(10) Paragraphs should be flush with the left margin. See the page 2 sample if your letter exceeds one page. Close the letter with the complimentary close (11,12) and optional components (13,14,15).

Sincerely, (11)

[Signature] (12)

[Your Name and Title]

[Identification Initials] (13)
 Enclosures: [Number] (14)

cc: [Name Copy sent to] (15)

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Margins 1-1.5"

1-1.5" Margin

1-1.5" Margin → [Your Name] ← 1
 [Address]
 [Address]
 [Phone]
 [Date today] ← 2
 Re: [To what this letter refers] ← 3

4 lines [CERTIFIED MAIL] ← 4
 [PERSONAL] ← 5

1 line [Recipient's Name] ← 6
 [Company Name]
 [Address]

1 line Attention [Recipient's Name] ← 7

1 line Dear [Recipient's Name]: ← 8

1 line [SUBJECT] ← 9

1 line The main characteristic of full block letters is that everything (except maybe a preprinted letterhead) is flush with the left margin. Full block letters are a little more formal than modified block letters. ← 10

1 line If your letter is only one page, type the complimentary close and optional components as shown below. Otherwise, type them on the last page of your letter. For the components of continuation pages, click on the link below to go to page 2 of this letter.

1 line Sincerely, ← 11

4 lines [Signature] ← 12

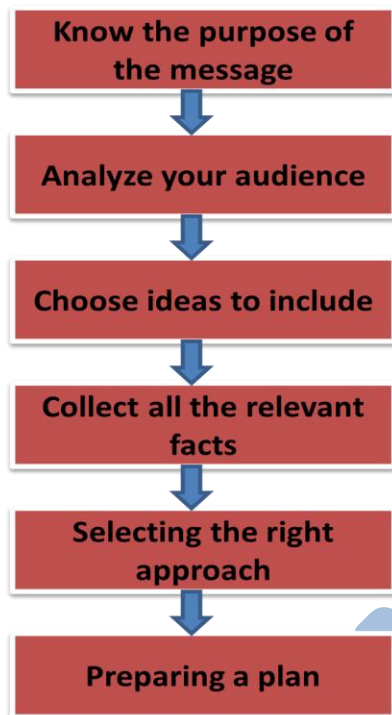
1 line [Your Name, Title]

1 line [Identification Initials] ← 13
 Enclosures: [Number] ← 14

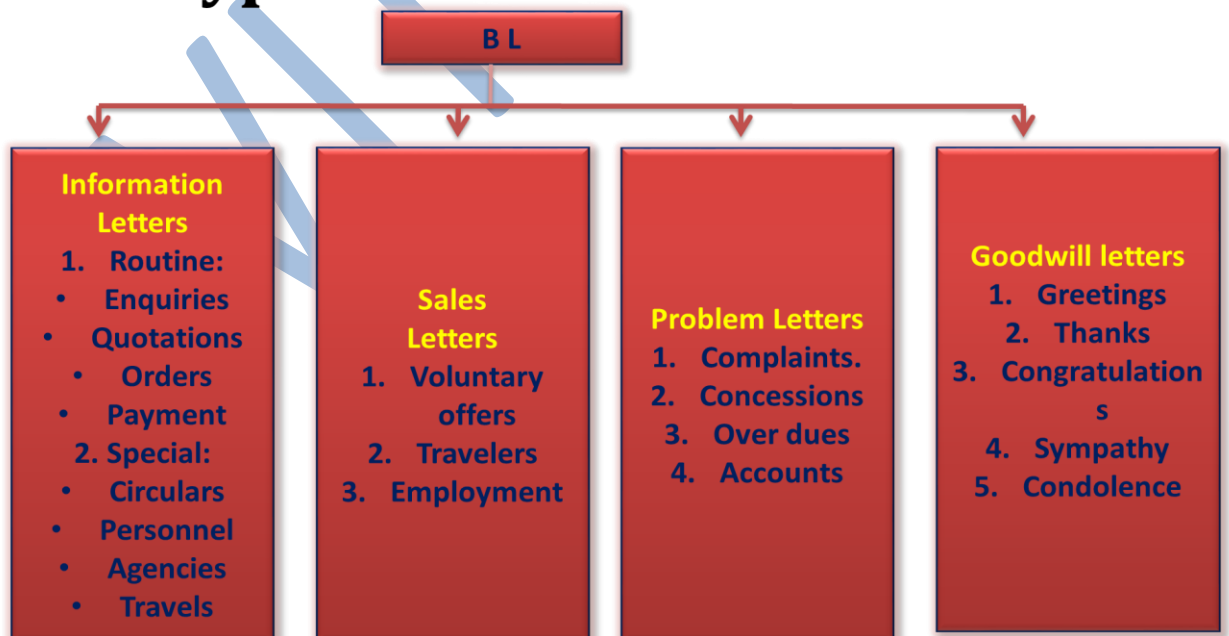
1 line cc: [Name For Copy] ← 15
 [Name For Copy]

1-1.5" Margin

Steps in writing a letter



Types of business letters



Types of business letters

Writing a Routine & Persuasive letters

- ❖ Letters are written only to persuade the reader to take an **action**.
- ❖ Persuasion does not occur in a single communication; it's a process and requires a **series of messages** through different media.
- ❖ Persuasive writing must be **simple, easy to understand, grammatically correct**, not have needless words, and use active voice.

Ex: Sales Letters

Persuasive techniques are needed for

- Sales
- Collection
- Bargaining
- Asking for favors
- Cover letters letter that attempt to make the reader accept alternatives and counter-proposals

Elements of Persuasion

- ▶ The writer's **credibility, reputation and expertise**
- ▶ The writer's concern for **reader's needs and desires**
- ▶ The writer must facilitate the action by pointing out in **which it can be done**
- ▶ The logic of the proposal must be **clear**
- ▶ The emotional appeal must **not go against the reader's beliefs, values and ethical principles**
- ▶ The tone must be **self-respecting and respectful towards the reader**

Positive & Negative Messages

- ▶ No organization can avoid writing **bad news letters**.
- ▶ There will be **requests of all kinds** from customers, employees, suppliers and members of public.
- ▶ Bad news letters have elements of **persuasion and information as well**.

Techniques to Convey Negative Messages

- ▶ Be clear about **your purpose** in the writing.
- ▶ Take a **positive attitude** and use **positive language**.
- ▶ **De-emphasize the negative** by placing it in positions of low emphasis.
- ▶ **Think carefully** of the reason for refusal.
- ▶ Offer a **substitute**.

Begin the letter in a positive way

- ▶ Begin by **thanking** the reader.
- ▶ In the main paragraph give **the explanation** and the bad news.
- ▶ **Present the justification/reasoning** for the bad news tactfully.

Write positive, friendly close

- ▶ Appreciation
- ▶ Invitation to future action
- ▶ Alternative
- ▶ Writer's Action
- ▶ Reader's Action
- ▶ Willingness to help
- ▶ Reader Benefit

In an **employee performance review**, managers evaluate that individual's overall performance, identify their strengths and weaknesses, offer feedback, and help them set goals. **Employees** typically have the opportunity to ask questions and share feedback with their manager as well.

What to include in an employee performance review

- Regardless of industry, most employee reviews include assessment of these skills:
- Communication
- Collaboration and teamwork
- Problem-solving
- Quality and accuracy of work

- Attendance, punctuality and reliability
- The ability to accomplish goals and meet deadlines

Employee reviews

A review should also include any company-specific or position-specific competencies, as well as the employee's accomplishments and contributions to their role or organization.

After addressing the key areas of assessment, you'll need to evaluate and weigh each to get a picture of the employee's overall performance. The way you format and organize this information is up to you as well as your company's needs. Some organizations use a grading system of A through F, numerical scoring or percentages, or written descriptions (e.g., "most of the time," "some of the time"). Whichever system you use, make sure that it is objective and easy to understand.

Once you finish the grading process, set up a time to discuss your findings with each employee. It can be helpful to have a written copy of the evaluation to reference and keep your meeting on track. Be sure to deliver transparent feedback, with examples where appropriate, and allot enough time for the employee to ask questions or deliver feedback.

ANNUAL PERFORMANCE REVIEW			
EMPLOYEE INFO			
EMPLOYEE NAME		DEPARTMENT	
EMPLOYEE ID		REVIEWER NAME	
POSITION HELD		REVIEWER TITLE	
LAST REVIEW DATE		TODAY'S DATE	
CURRENT RESPONSIBILITIES			
<i>Attach job description, noting any significant changes.</i>			
PERFORMANCE ASSESSMENT			
<i>Evaluate performance and achieved goals.</i>			
<i>Discuss areas of excellence within performance.</i>			
<i>Discuss areas of improvement.</i>			
<i>Develop future goals with set expectations.</i>			
COMMENTS AND APPROVAL			
<i>Provide any additional feedback.</i>			
EMPLOYEE SIGNATURE		REVIEWER SIGNATURE	

Recommendation Letter

[Date]

Re: Recommendation for Sharon Westman

Dear Hiring Manager:

I was initially impressed with Sharon Westman's enthusiasm, communication skills and professional demeanor when I hired her four years ago as a customer service rep within JRW Inc.'s call center. During the two years Sharon reported to me (I have since moved on to a different department), she consistently demonstrated all of these qualities and more, and I heartily endorse her for any customer service position.

Sharon is reliable, dedicated and eternally upbeat. Her ability to calm angry or frustrated customers is unparalleled, and it is because of her excellence in this area that I repeatedly asked her to mentor new employees in the call center. Sharon multitasks effectively and is able to handle a high-volume workload. She consistently met or surpassed all weekly call center metrics (including customer satisfaction, call volume and response time), and her daily written reports were accurate and thorough.

Of particular value to me as a former call center manager was Sharon's team player mind-set, enthusiastic embrace of change, ability to work with minimal supervision and unwavering commitment to exceeding customer expectations. I regularly received unsolicited praise from customers commending Sharon's outstanding level of service, professionalism and follow-through.

Organized and diligent, Sharon quickly learned technology systems and software that were unfamiliar to her when she first started with JRW, and she also attended optional professional-development seminars offered through the company. She is pursuing an associate's degree in business through evening classes at ABC Community College.

Sharon is a hardworking, top-performing customer service professional. She has my highest recommendation, and I am happy to furnish more details if you would like additional information.

Sincerely,

Carla Pederson
Field Service Manager (former Call Center Manager)
JRW Inc.
(555) 555-5555

Thank you letter



Sample Thank You Letter

Date

Name

Title

Company Name

Address

City, State, Zip

Dear Mr./Ms. _____:

Many thanks for your most generous gift of _____ amount or in-kind contribution to _____ your organization name _____, which we received in our office on _____ date _____. In compliance with the tax code of the Internal Revenue Service, we confirm that you received no goods or services of monetary value from _____ company name _____ in connection with this gift, making the above amount fully deductible for tax purposes.

As a result of _____ company name's gift, _____ your organization's name will be able to continue to _____ give specific things that you can accomplish and relate these to your mission.

As acknowledgment of your gift, your company's name will be listed as it appears below. To make a change or correction, please contact _____ contact person's name in your organization and phone number _____.

Once again, many thanks for your generous support. We are exceedingly grateful.

Sincerely,

Name

Title

Official Corporation Name
Corporation Contact Name
Address

From Ballet Austin Tool-kit

Memo (Memorandum)

- ▶ A Memo is used for **internal communication**, that is among members of the organization.
- ▶ It is a short piece of writing generally used by the officers of an organization for communicating among them.
- ▶ Memo is a written statement that you prepare specially for a person or committee in order to give them information about a particular matter.
- ▶ It may be from one person to another or to many persons.
- ▶ **To ask** for information.
- ▶ **To give** information.
- ▶ **To request** approval, comment, decision or action.
- ▶ To **seek** explanation on some matter.

Memo Format

Memo has two subjects

- ▶ **The heading**
- ▶ **the body**

A Memo format may be vertical or horizontal

In the **vertical format** all the lines of formal information begin at the left margin

Date:

To:

From:

Subject:

In the **horizontal format**, the “To” and “From” lines at the left margin, while the “Date” and “Subject” are at the right

To:

Date:

From:

Subject:

Drafting a Memo

- ▶ A well-written memo is **informative and concise**
- ▶ Informative by the **principles of preparation and organization**
- ▶ **Preparation:** decide the exact objective
- ▶ **Organization of content:** it can be organized by decreasing order of importance or increasing the order of importance

Memo Style

- ▶ A Memo is always **brief**
- ▶ **Be cordial, straight ward, lucid** but formal
- ▶ **Use caution in negative situations** too much technical jargon or complicated sentences are not suitable for any business communication

Writing Reports

- A Report is a logical and systematic presentation of facts and information related to a specific topic.
- A report can be defined as a communication in which the writer gives information to some individual or organization because it is his or her responsibility to do so.
- It is an assigned communication for a purpose & for a specific receiver/ reader.
- A written statement of the facts of a situation, a project, a process or a test; how these facts were ascertained; their significance; the conclusions that have been drawn from them; the recommendations that are being made.

Writing a proposal

- A proposal is the presentation of an idea that you wish to pursue.
- A good proposal presumes that you have already thought about your project and have devoted some time and effort in gathering information, reading, and then organizing your thoughts.
- **A proposal is NOT a project to be thrown together in one night with ideas off the top of your head.** Thus, one might say that the research proposal is a second step, following the selection of a broad topic.
- The actual proposal will indicate what analytical question you wish to address. The foundation of a good research paper is a good research question. Just a tree needs a

good root system to grow to be strong, a good research paper needs a good analytical question.

The specific parts of the proposal are as follows:

1. Statement of the question your paper will answer. Again, remember, the point of your paper is to explain something.
2. Brief literature review in which you review the major works on your topic and indicate what the arguments are. If you are applying a theory to an issue, you can review the theory used. The point is to show an awareness of what has been written on your issue, what evidence was used, what theories applied, and what arguments were made.
3. A statement as to what your argument/explanation will be.
4. A statement as to how your explanation/argument will differ from that which has been made by other authors. How is your explanation original or different? If you applying a theory, you can explain which theory you will use and why you think that is the appropriate theory to explain the event(s) you are interested in.
5. A brief outline of the parts of the paper.
6. A short bibliography/statement as to the major sources you will use. This can include databases, websites, interviews, etc.
7. The proposal need not be long, but the quality should be high. I would think that 3-4 pages would be sufficient. The more effort you put into your proposal the better your paper will be. Also, the more detailed your proposal, the more I can comment and usefully guide you to a good paper.
8. You should have a proposal prepared and submitted to me No Later than one month after class begins. Start early; the earlier the better.
9. A proposal which does not follow directions is liable to be returned to you for you to re-do.

How to Write a Project Proposal

- Title page
- Project title
- Contents page
- Abstract
- Context
- Project justification/aim
- Target group

- Project implementation
- Budget
- Monitoring and evaluation
- Reporting
- Management and personnel
- Annexures

CONCLUSION

Written Communication plays a very important role in every organization.

Written messages should be composed carefully as a slight mistake may give entirely different meaning to a situation.
